A Health Check of India's IT Services in 2026

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Written as part of SPAR (Fall 2026), supervised by Andrei Potlogea. Data and code: github.com/niranjan-deshpande/Indian-IT-AI-Forecasting.

Summary

India's IT services industry has long been central to the country's economy and, for many graduates, a path into the urban middle class. [1] Recent advances in LLM capabilities have inspired worry that this sector is collapsing: if agentic tools can do much of the work of companies like Infosys and Wipro, how will the companies survive, and, more importantly, what will happen to employment in them? [2]

But it's not immediately clear that the effects will be negative. On the one hand, AI tools might decrease the demand for IT services because clients can do more work in-house, which would decrease the total number of workers needed. They could also reduce the number of engineers needed for a given level of demand.

On the other hand, AI tools could make IT services cheaper and thereby *increase* demand. In this world, employment might remain steady or even rise.

In this piece, we look at what publicly available data can tell us about these two scenarios. At present, the evidence weakly suggests that India's IT services sector is still growing, but that it is adding fewer jobs than it did before, disproportionately among young graduates.

More specifically:

1. **Output is growing.** Exports of software and IT-enabled services were $221 billion in FY26, which is 19% more than they were in FY23. Meanwhile, India's share of world computer-services exports has stayed at about 30% since 2022.
2. **The largest firms are slowing down.** The six biggest IT services firms grew revenue by between 0.6% and 3.2% a year in constant currency over FY24–26, against about 9% before COVID. We suspect this is because growth has moved to the captive centres of foreign firms (GCCs), mid-sized firms and business-process firms.

3. **Although output has grown, employment has lagged.** The six biggest firms employ 3.7% fewer people than in March 2023. Across the sector, employment is growing by at most about 2% a year, against about 4% a year before COVID. [3]
4. **The entry level has narrowed.** Fresher hiring is well below its FY22 peak. It fell to a low in FY24, while firms found work for the staff they had hired during the boom, and has since partly recovered. IT's share of young graduates, of young formal-sector entrants and of entry-level openings is lower than before the boom ended.
5. **Other indicators of firm health are largely normal.** Attrition is back to its pre-COVID level, utilisation is at or above its pre-COVID average, and margins have not changed much. AI-related price cuts, as implied by management statements on earnings calls, were about 0.4% in FY26; firms expect about 1.5% in FY27.

We should note that, regardless of how the industry *currently* looks, things might change rapidly very soon. The summer of 2026 saw a jump in coding-agent capability that could upset this balance, and almost all of our data predate it.

Table 1. Summary indicators

Indicator	Latest	Comparison	Source
Software and IT-enabled services exports	$221bn (FY26)	$186bn in FY23	RBI
India's share of world computer-services exports, excluding Ireland	30.1% (2025)	29.3% in 2022	IMF
Revenue growth, six largest firms, constant currency	0.6% (FY26)	8.7% a year in FY16–20	Filings
Revenue growth in US dollars, four mid-tier firms	14.9% (FY26)	2.2% for the six largest	Filings
Headcount, six largest firms	1.62m (Mar 2026)	1.68m in Mar 2023	Filings
Employment in IT (NIC 62–63)	5.7m (2025)	5.5m in 2022-23	PLFS
Employment, industry estimate	5.95m (FY26)	+2.3% on FY25	Nasscom
Fresher hires, TCS, Infosys and HCLTech	76,000 (FY26)	218,000 in FY22	Filings
IT share of salaried graduates aged 21–25	16% (2025)	20% in 2022-23	PLFS
IT share of net payroll additions aged 18–25	3.9% (FY25)	5.8% in FY22	EPFO
Real monthly pay, IT workers aged 21–25	₹30,900 (2025)	₹35,200 in 2024	PLFS
Attrition, six largest firms	12–14% (Jun 2026)	22–28% at the 2022 peak	Filings
Labour share of value added, six largest firms	0.71 (FY26)	0.69 in FY22	Filings
AI-related price cuts	0.4% (FY26)	about 1.5% expected in FY27	Earnings calls

Constant-currency growth removes exchange-rate effects. PLFS 2025 uses a redesigned survey; the change since 2022-23 is not statistically significant. Sources and definitions are in the appendix.

1 Introduction

Since the 1990s, IT services have grown into one of the main routes into salaried work for India's graduates, and the main one for engineers. [4] The sector employs about six million people, and its exports are worth about 5½% of GDP. [5] But in February 2026, as investors priced in AI coding tools,

share prices of the largest firms fell sharply. Headlines have since claimed both that AI is hollowing out Indian IT and that its exports are booming. [6]

Here, we collect evidence on how the sector is doing now. We draw on filings of the six largest firms and 21 smaller listed firms, RBI and IMF trade data, the government's labour force survey (PLFS), provident-fund payroll records (EPFO), engineering-college placement data, job-postings indices, earnings-call transcripts and price data. We also use estimates from industry bodies and private firms; where we cannot check one against public data, we say so, and Section 8 audits the most widely cited.

Importantly, we don't try to make causal claims about the impact of AI on the sector. This is intended to be a descriptive health check. In a future piece, we'll use these data to back out the key parameters and forecast the sector's trajectory. [7]

We read "IT services" broadly, to include IT services firms, business-process management (BPM), engineering services and GCCs. Unless otherwise stated, years are Indian fiscal years ending in March.

2 Output has kept growing

By the RBI's annual survey, India exported $221 billion of software and IT-enabled services in FY26. That is 8.2% more than in FY25 and 19% more than in FY23, or about 6% a year in dollars. In FY26 the growth came from IT services, which rose 12%, while BPO exports were flat. [8]

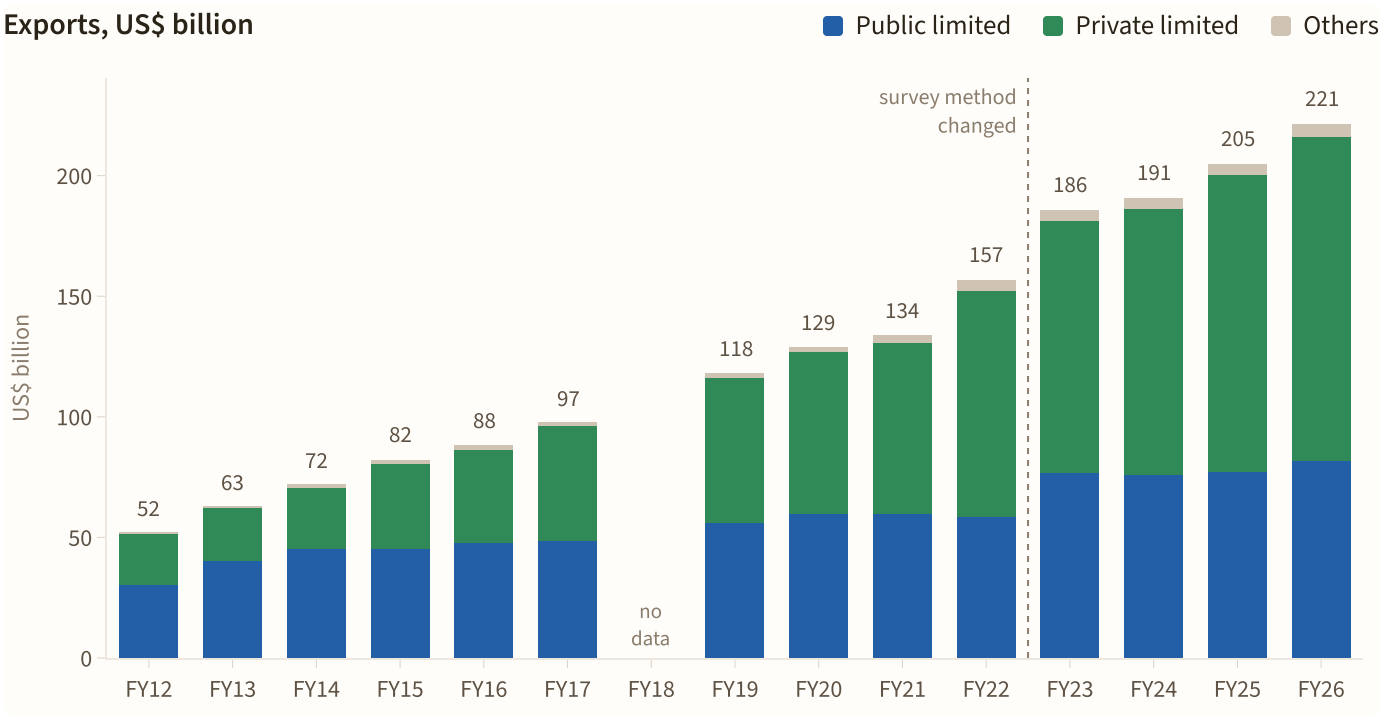


Figure 1. Software and IT-enabled services exports by type of exporter, FY12–FY26, US$ billion. Public-limited exporters include the large listed Indian firms; private-limited exporters include GCCs, foreign-owned vendors and unlisted Indian firms. The survey method changed around FY23.

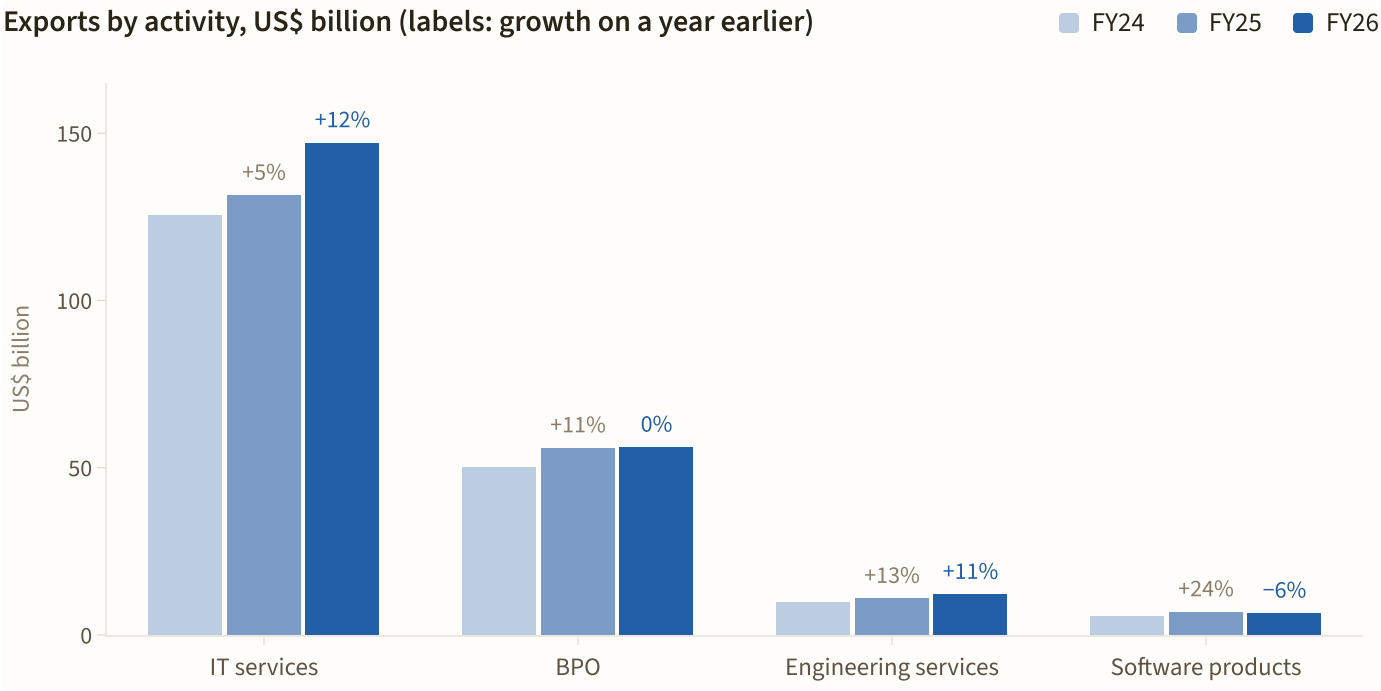


Figure 2. Exports by activity, FY24–FY26, US$ billion. IT services drove the growth in FY26; in FY25, IT services and BPO added similar amounts.

Next, we consider whether India is losing this work to other countries. This turns out not to be the case: India's share of world computer-services exports, excluding Ireland, was 29.3% in 2022 and 30.1% in 2025. [9] In the first half of 2026 India's computer-services exports grew 11%, as fast as those of 24 other delivery countries combined.

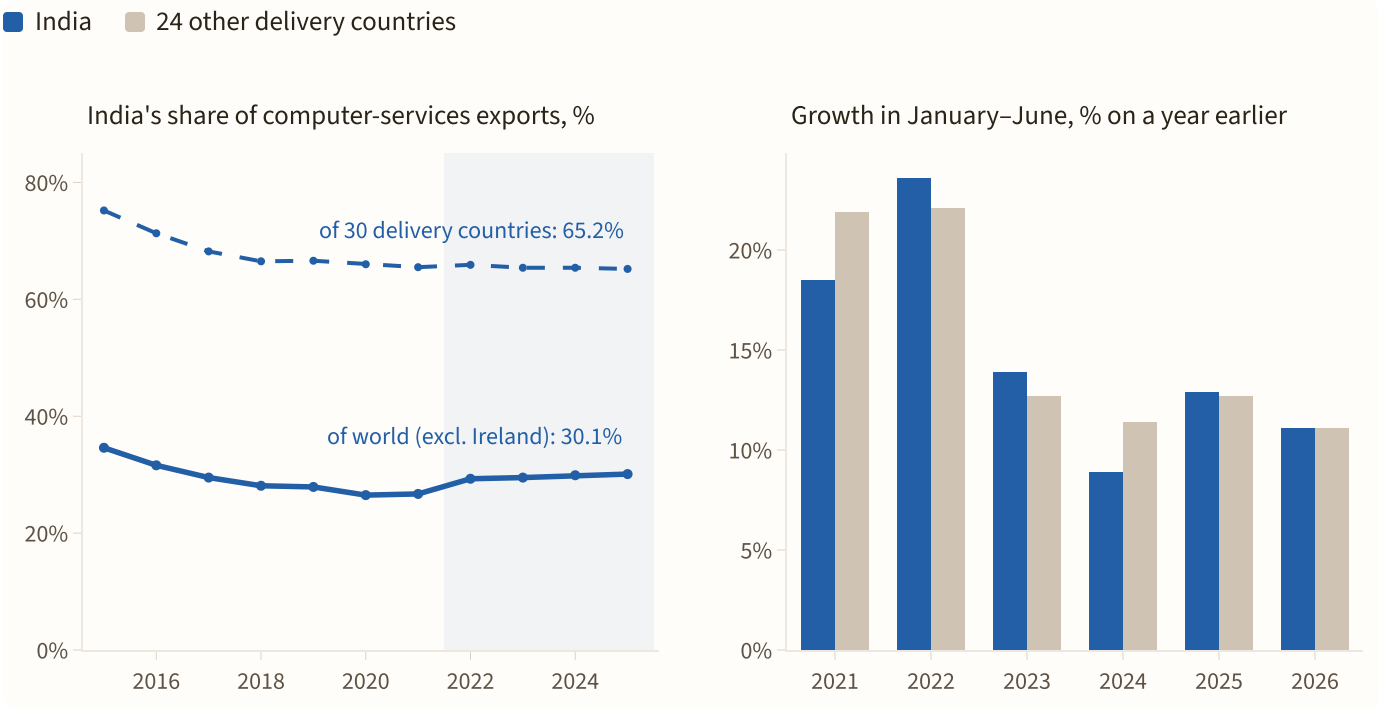
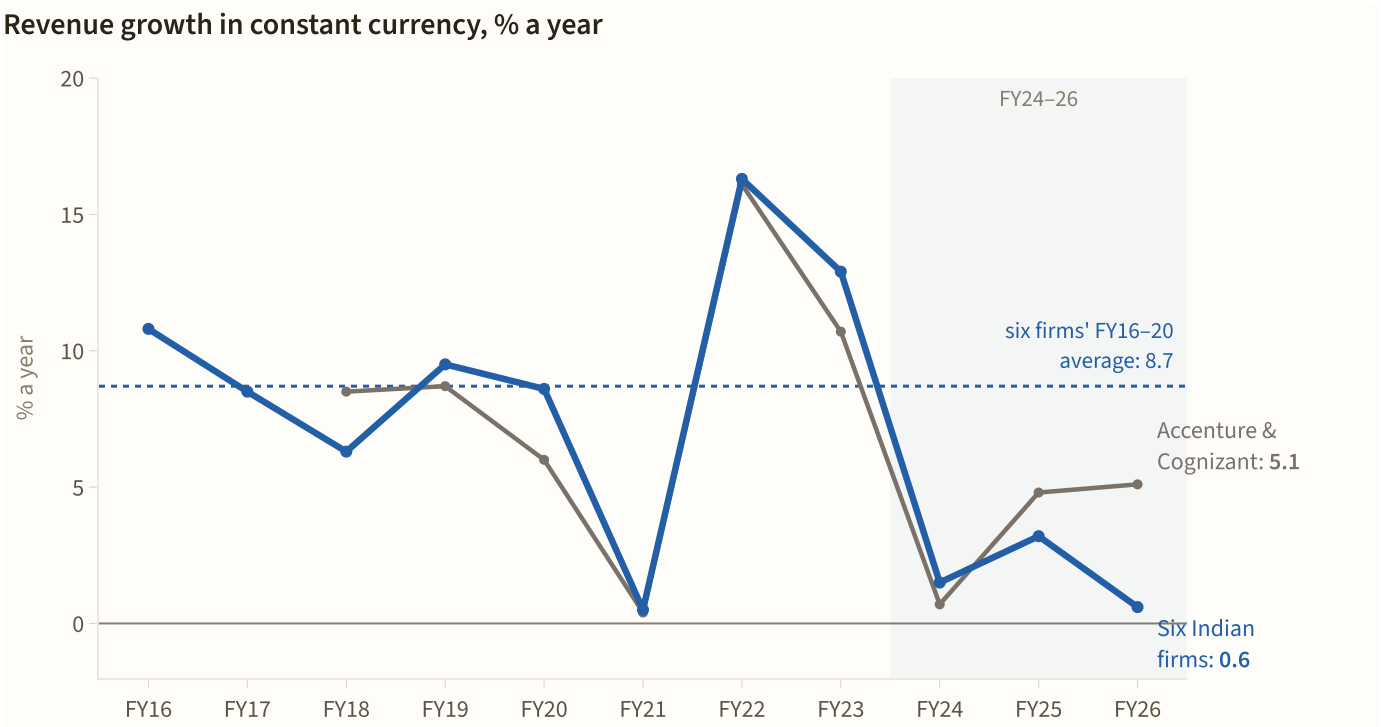


Figure 3. India's share of world computer-services exports (excluding Ireland) and of exports from 30 emerging delivery countries, 2015–2025. The share fell before 2022 and has been flat since.

3 Growth has moved away from the largest firms

The six largest IT services firms in India are TCS, Infosys, HCLTech, Wipro, Tech Mahindra and LTIMindtree. They earned $86 billion in FY26, 7% more than in FY23, while total exports grew 19%. However, their constant-currency growth fell from 8.7% a year in FY16–20 to 1.5%, 3.2% and 0.6% in FY24–26.

We compare them with two international firms, Accenture and Cognizant. Both compete for the same clients as the six Indian firms, and both deliver mostly from India. Accenture and Cognizant grew about 5% in FY26.



Growth is in log points (×100), which is close to % at these rates; the text quotes the same measure. The Accenture–Cognizant line is the simple average of the two and starts in FY18, the first year with Cognizant data. The Indian line covers four firms to FY20 and five in FY21–23 (all six from FY24).

Figure 4. Annual revenue growth in constant currency, FY16–FY26: the six largest Indian firms (weighted by revenue) and the average of Accenture and Cognizant. Until FY23 the two groups moved together; since then the Indian firms have grown more slowly.

All these firms over-hired after COVID. Accenture's revenue is back on its pre-COVID trend; that of the six firms is about 16% below it.

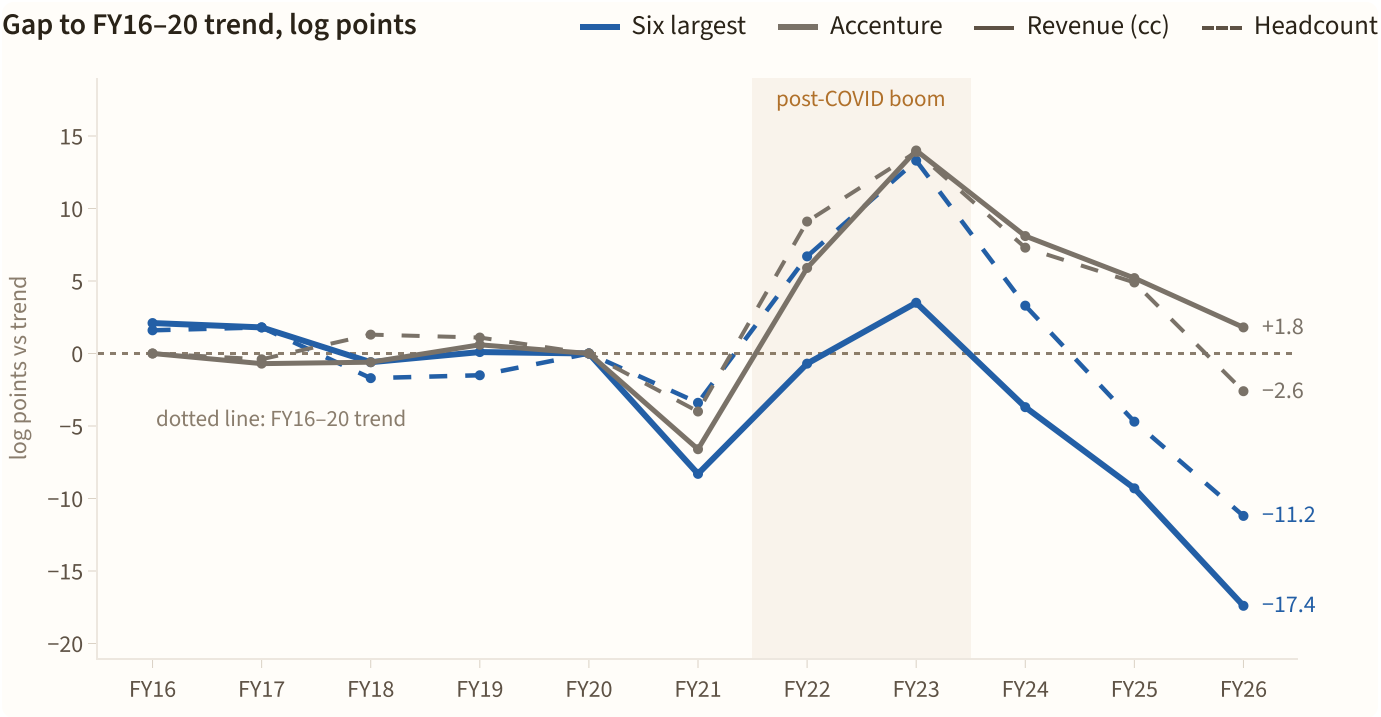


Figure 5. Revenue and headcount relative to each firm group's FY16–20 trend, log points. Zero means on trend.

However, this slowdown is uneven among the six companies. TCS revenue shrank in constant currency in each of the four quarters to March 2026, while LTIMindtree and Tech Mahindra grew 6–7% in the latest quarter. The weakness is concentrated in particular firms rather than in particular client industries or regions: across firms and segments in FY24–26, differences between firms explain about 40% of the variation in growth by client industry and by region, while the client industry or region itself explains 2–6%.

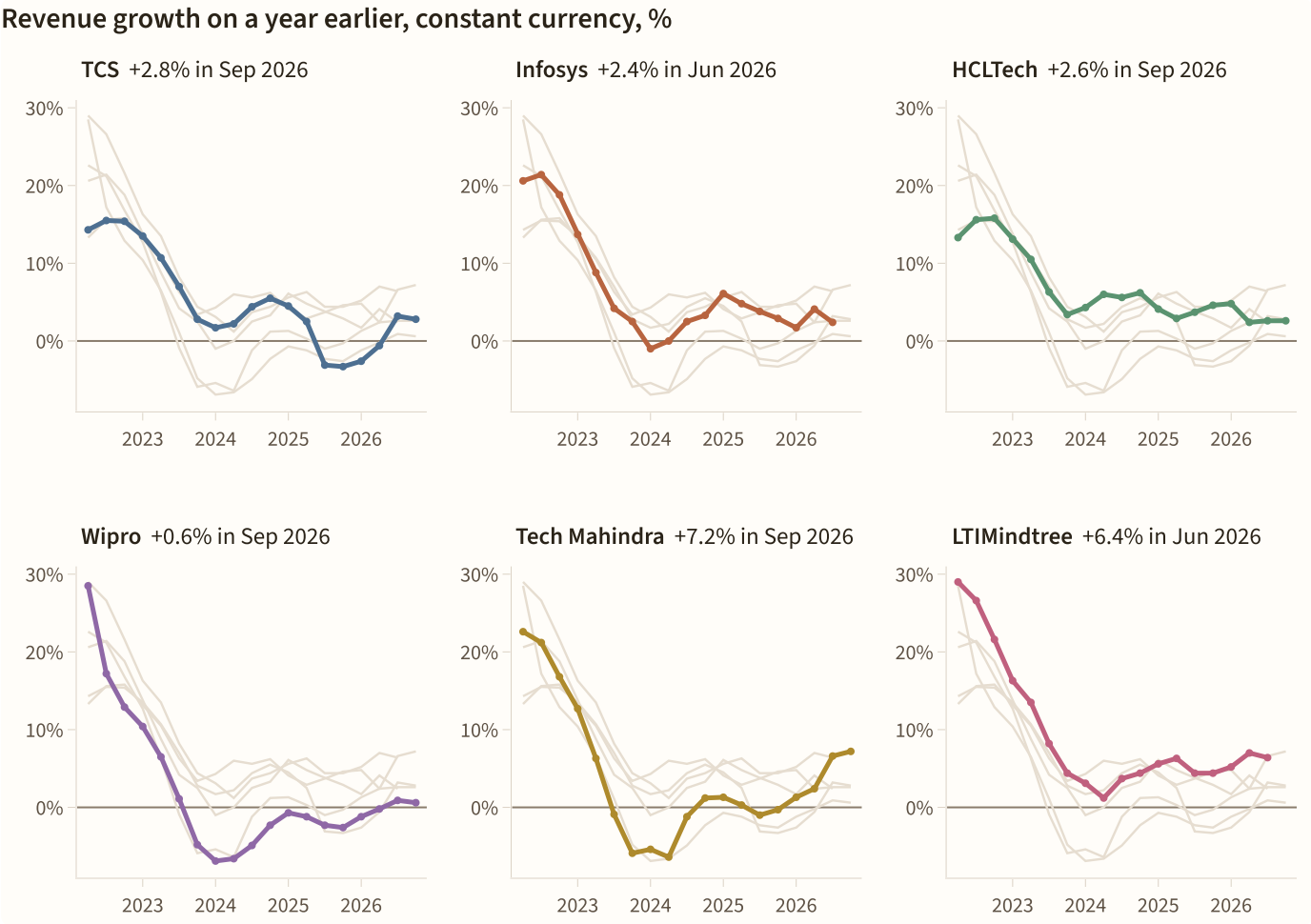


Figure 6. Year-on-year constant-currency revenue growth by firm, quarterly, 2022 to September 2026.

We then investigate whether other players in the market took up this slack. This seems to be the case. Between FY23 and FY26, the four largest mid-tier firms (Persistent, Coforge, Mphasis and Hexaware) raised dollar revenue by 39%. Three listed BPM firms raised theirs by 48%. Meanwhile, GCCs added roughly 260,000 technology jobs, within a wide range. [10]

The gains were not shared by every smaller firm, though. We also track 12 other listed IT and engineering-services firms. Together they grew headcount by only 2% over the three years, net of acquisitions, and five of them shrank.

The RBI's export survey shows the same shift from another angle. It splits exporters into publicly listed companies, which include the six largest firms, and privately held ones, which include GCCs, foreign-owned vendors and unlisted Indian firms. The privately held companies' share of exports rose from 35% in FY13 to 61% in FY26 (Figure 1). That shift has been steady for more than a decade; it did not speed up after 2023. [11]

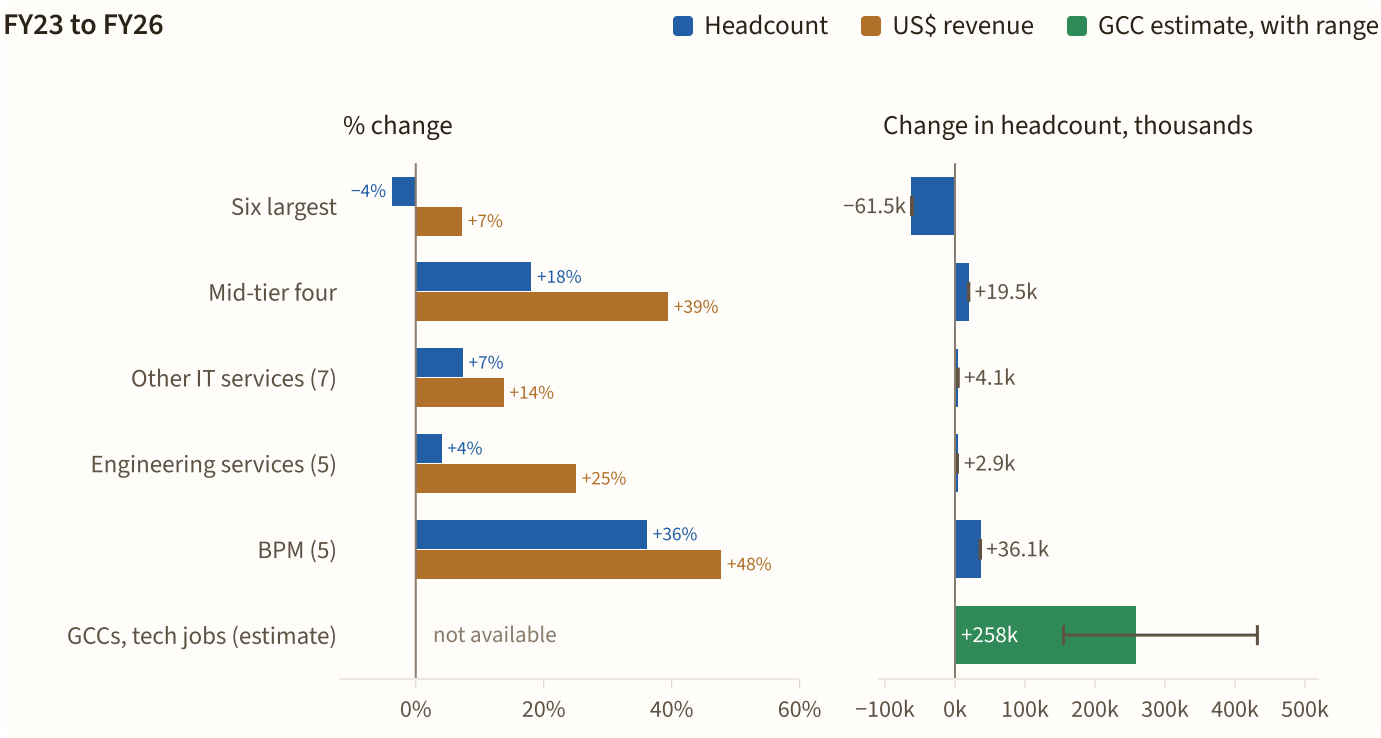


Figure 7. Change in headcount and US-dollar revenue, FY23 to FY26, by segment. GCC employment is a range of estimates of technology jobs added. Listed-firm headcounts are global.

4 Employment has not kept pace

Next, we turn to employment. For the sector's role as a ladder for graduates, jobs matter more than revenue, and they are where a labour-saving technology would show up first.

Headcount at the six firms peaked at 1.69 million in September 2022. It fell about 4% in FY24 and has been roughly flat since, at 1.62 million in March 2026. In the quarter to September 2026, the four firms that have reported added 9,400 people, mostly freshers.

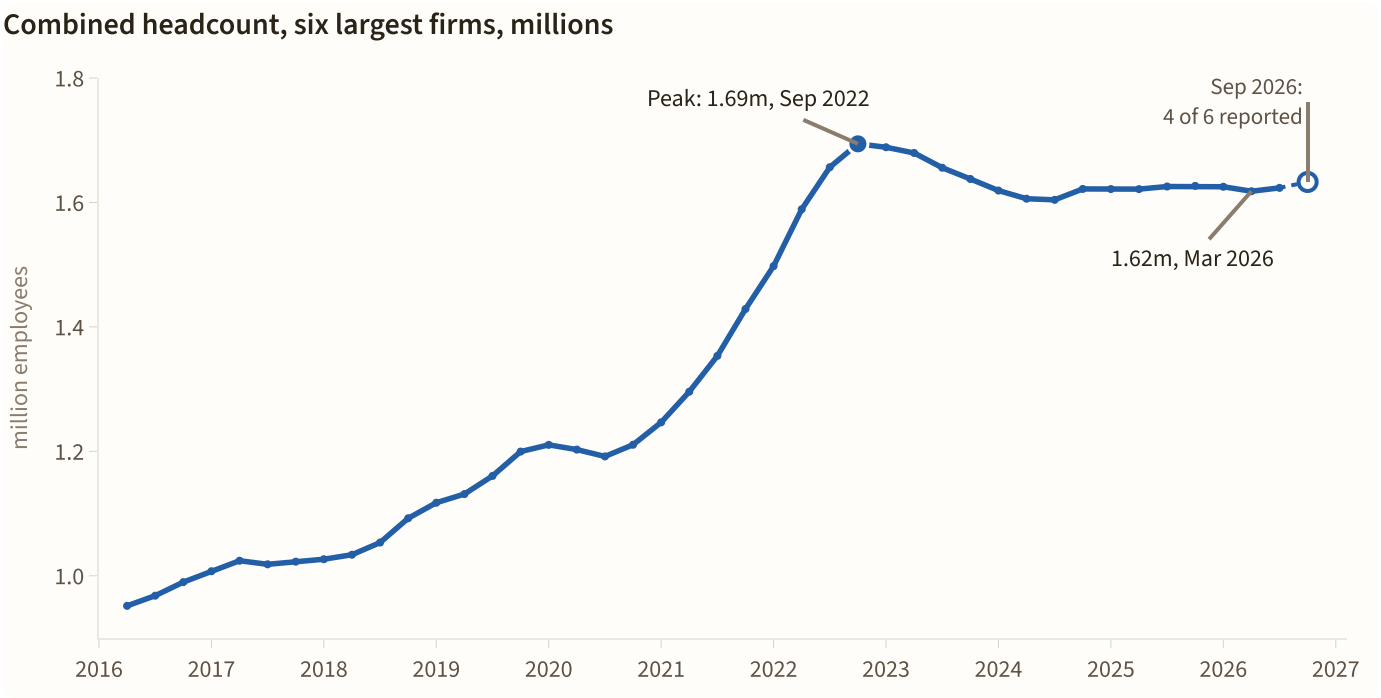


Figure 8. Combined headcount of the six largest firms, quarterly, 2015 to September 2026. The last point includes only four firms' new figures.

With revenue still growing, revenue per employee has risen, from $48,600 at the end of 2022 to $53,900 in mid-2026.

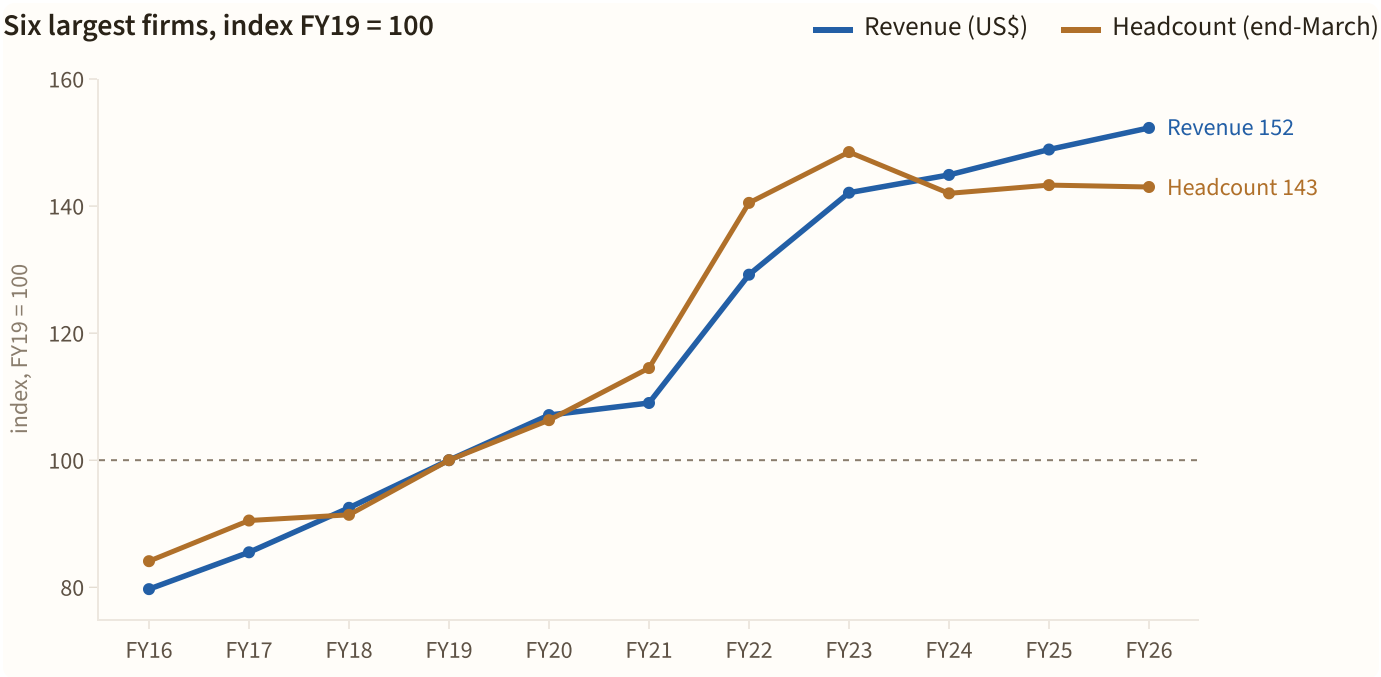


Figure 9. Revenue and headcount of the six largest firms, indexed to FY19 = 100.

Across the whole sector, the evidence points to slow growth. Nasscom estimates 5.95 million employees in FY26, 2.3% more than a year earlier, while its revenue estimate rose 6.1%. The PLFS counts 5.7 million people working in IT (NIC 62–63) in 2025, 4% more than in 2022-23. [12] The survey's margin of error, from −7% to +15%, cannot tell that apart from no growth or from 2% a year. Another half a million software and ICT workers are employed in other industries, about 190,000 more than in 2022-23; many are probably GCC staff classified under their parent firm's industry.

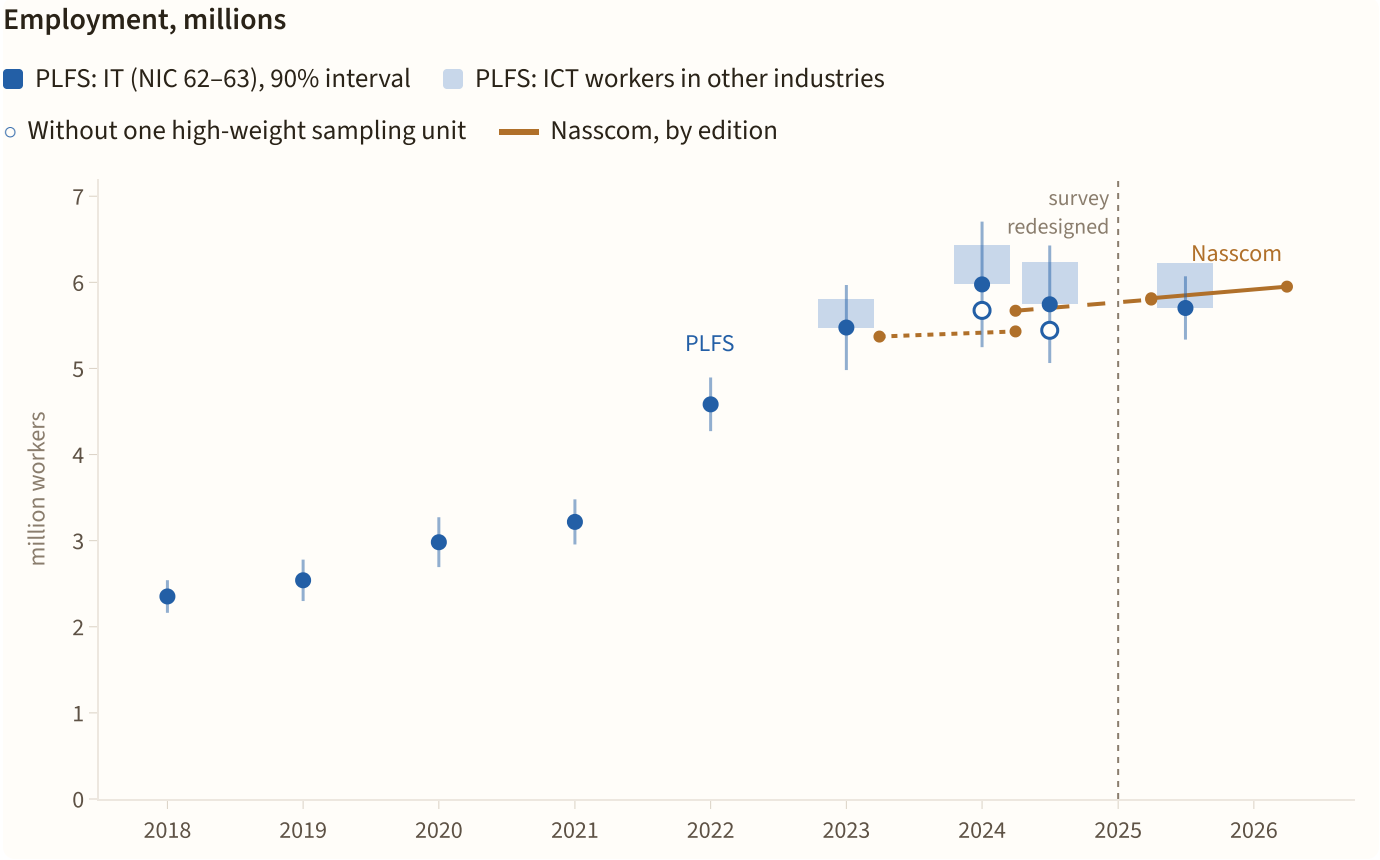


Figure 10. Employment in IT (NIC 62–63) from the PLFS, with 90% confidence intervals, and Nasscom's industry estimate, which is revised with each edition. The shaded portion counts ICT workers in other industries. The 2025 survey was redesigned.

– How many jobs has the sector added?

Four estimates circulate. Read like for like, they agree with each other and with slow growth.

- **Nasscom:** +135,000 in FY26 (+2.3%). This includes GCCs and BPM, and is published before the year ends.
- **Goldman Sachs, via the World Bank:** the six largest firms shed about 64,000 jobs over three years, which our data reproduce (63,557), while the rest of the sector "added around 700,000".

[13] About 240,000 of that is Nasscom adding GCCs to its count. Like for like, the figure is about 390,000.

- **ICRIER:** “employment has continued to grow”. This rests on PLFS data for 2021-22 to 2023-24, which we reproduce. It ends before the flat period. [14]
- **PLFS:** +4% from 2022-23 to 2025, with a margin of error of about ±11 points.

5 The entry level has narrowed

The FY22 hiring boom was extreme. TCS, Infosys and HCLTech hired about 218,000 freshers that year. By FY25 they hired 65,000, and in FY26 76,000. Staffing firms’ estimates for the whole sector have the same shape, though their figures for the peak range from 400,000 to 600,000. [15] Hiring bottomed in FY24. In the boom the firms had hired far ahead of their revenue: in FY23 their headcount was about 15% above its pre-COVID trend, but their revenue only about 3.5% above. In FY24 they put those staff to work rather than recruit new ones, and some delayed onboarding offers they had already made. [16] Hiring has picked up since. TCS and Infosys together hired 64,000 freshers in FY26, more than the 50,000 they hired in FY16, though staffing firms’ estimates for the whole sector remain below pre-COVID levels. Stated targets for FY27 are lower: 25,000 offers at TCS, 20,000 at Infosys, and none announced at Wipro or HCLTech.

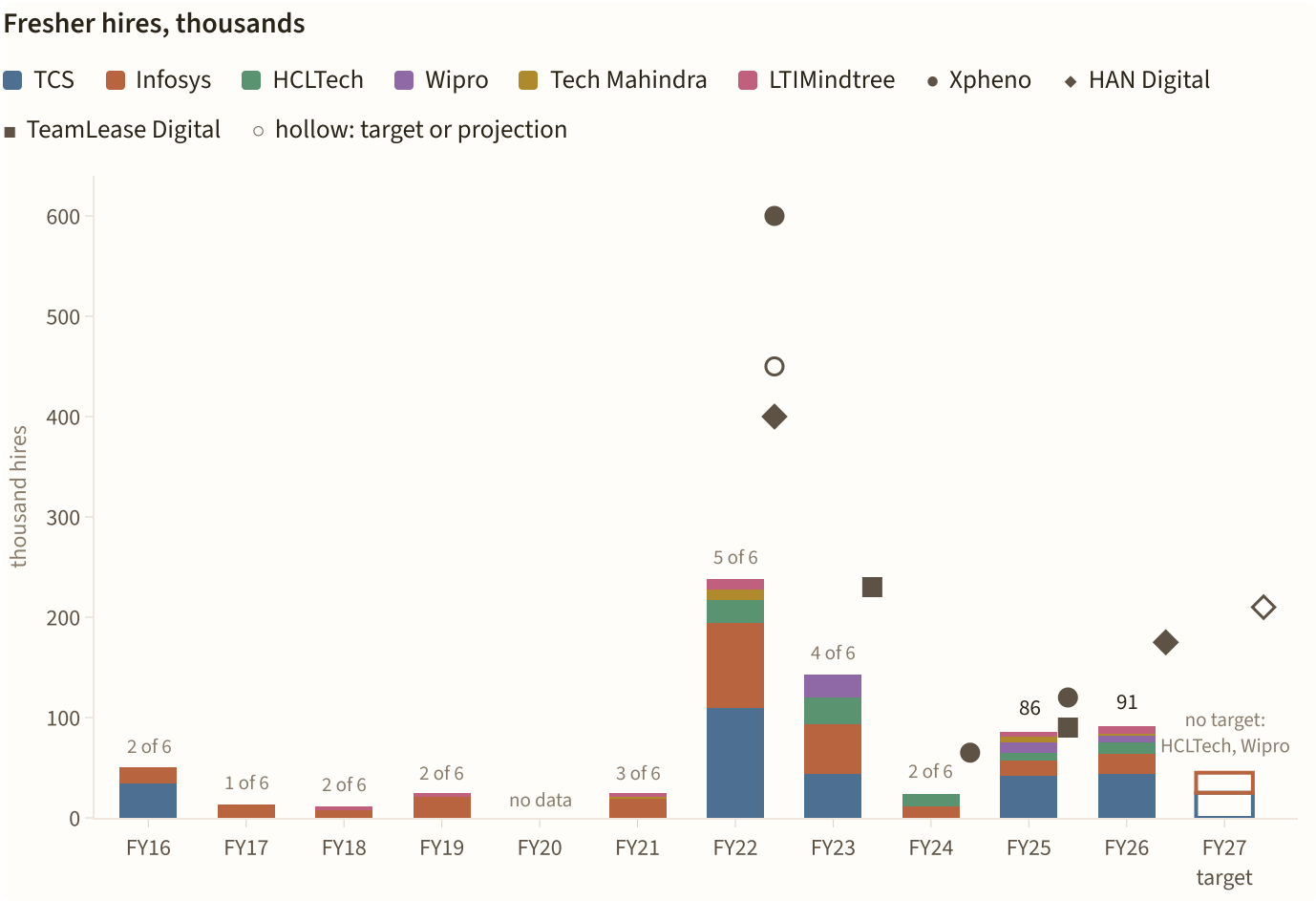


Figure 11. Fresher hires at the largest firms, FY16–FY26, with stated FY27 targets (hollow bars) and third-party estimates for the whole sector (points; hollow points are projections).

The clearer signal is in shares. On every measure we have, IT's share of young entrants has fallen, while young graduates found more jobs elsewhere. Salaried graduates aged 21–25 working in IT held at about one million from 2022-23 to 2025, while salaried jobs for that age group grew by about a third.

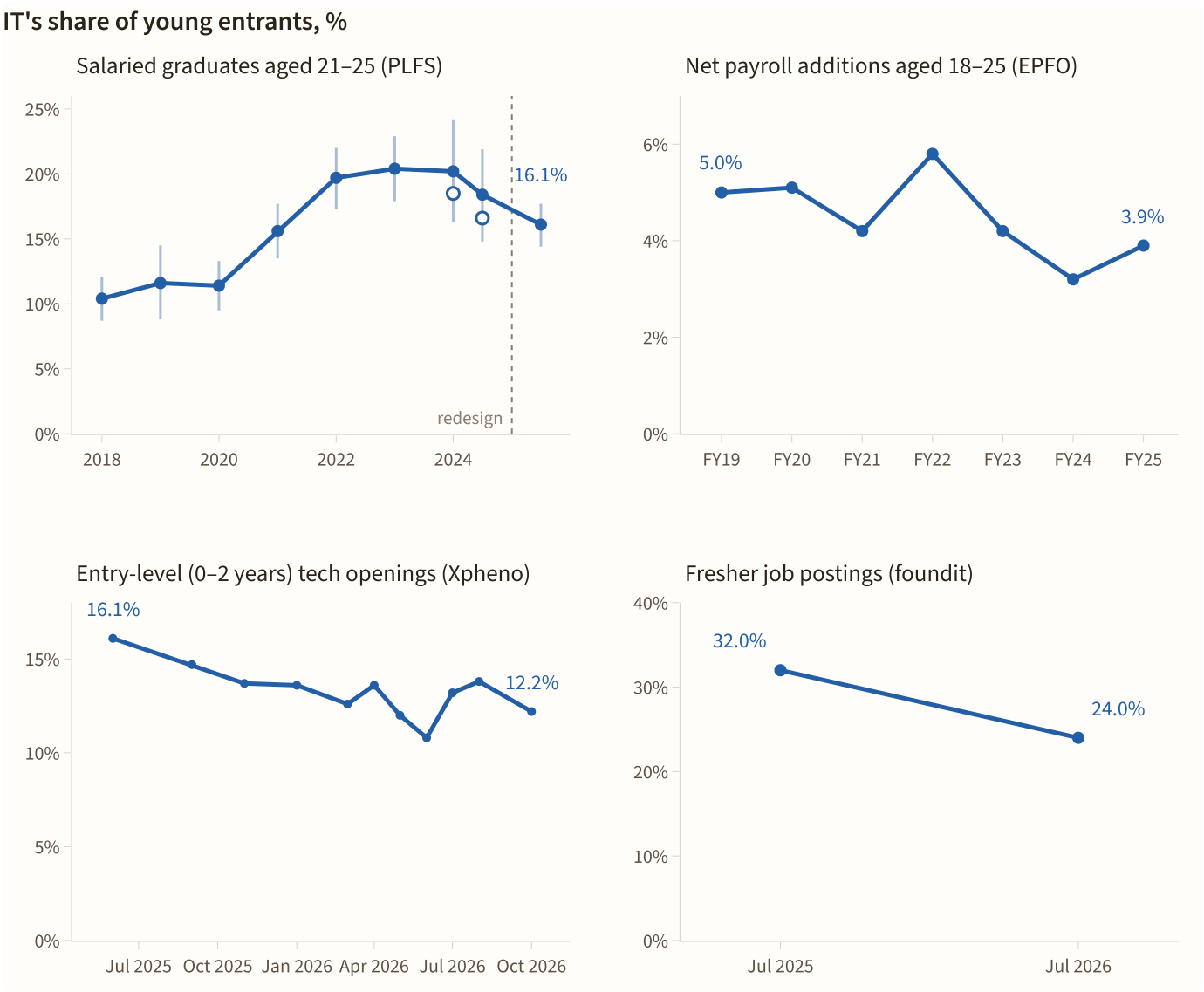


Figure 12. IT's share of four flows of young entrants: salaried graduates aged 21–25 (PLFS); net payroll additions aged 18–25 (EPFO); entry-level (0–2 years) technology openings (Xpheno); and fresher job postings (foundit). [17]

Inside the firms, the workforce has grown older. The share of employees under 30 fell after FY23 at 8 of 10 large firms. At Infosys, the junior grade fell from 46% of staff in FY23 to 30% in FY26. [18]

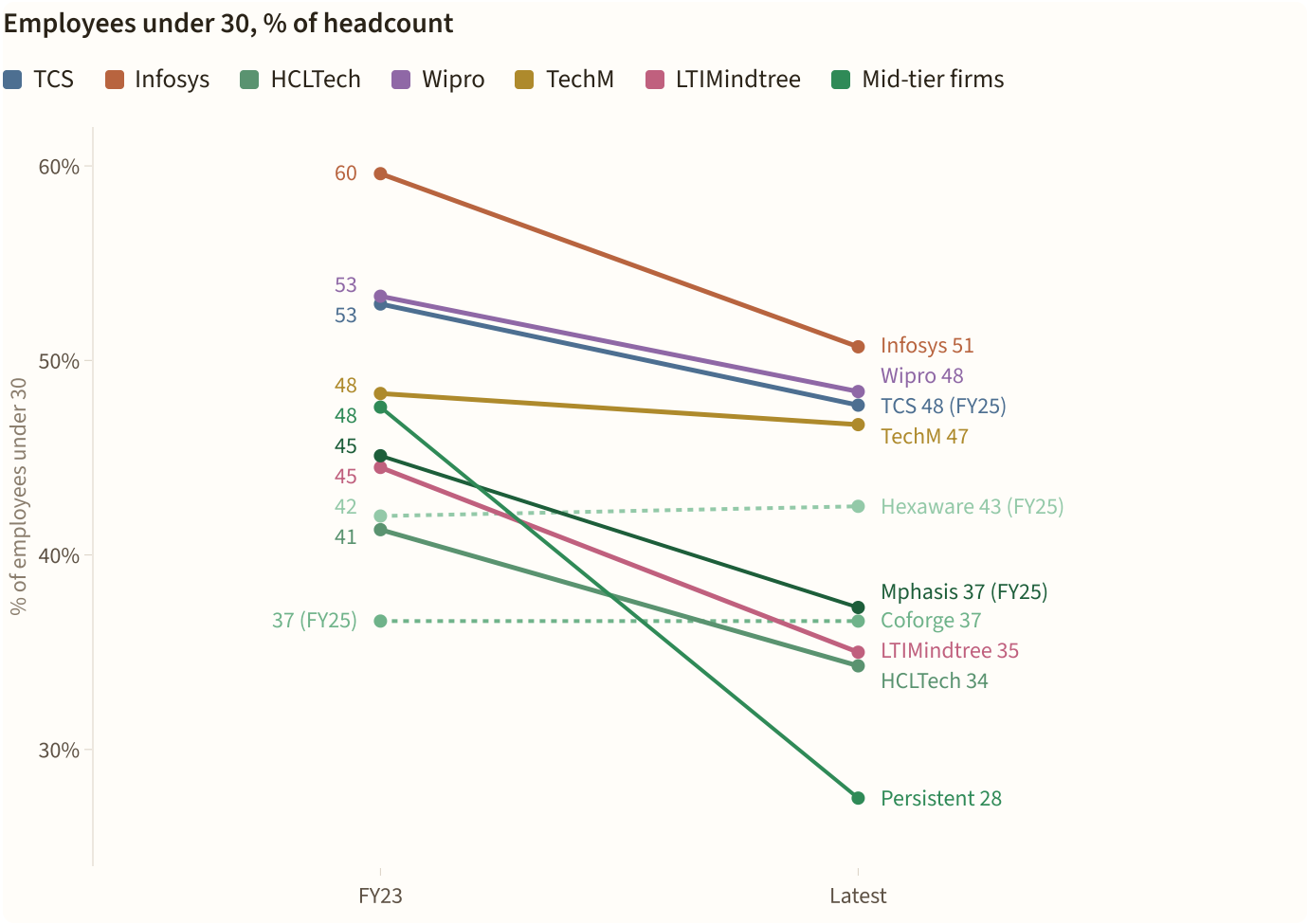


Figure 13. Share of employees under 30, FY23 and latest year, ten large firms.

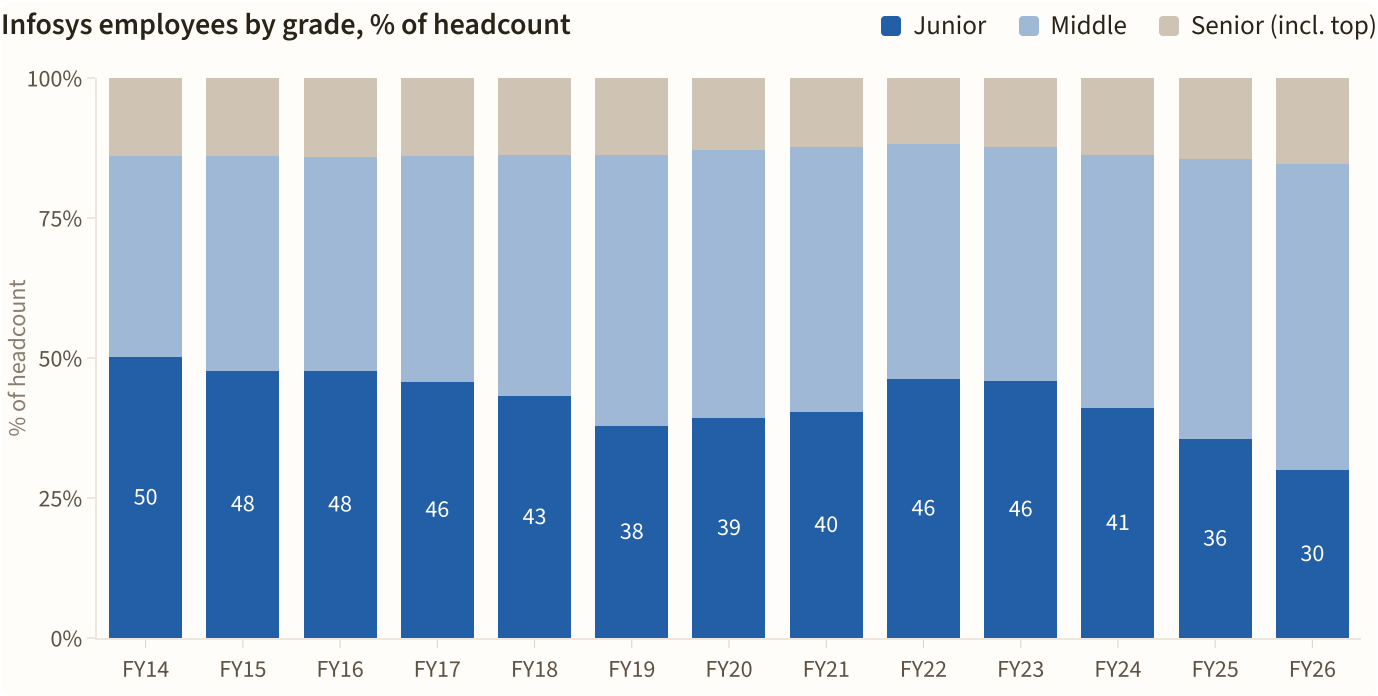


Figure 14. Infosys employees by grade, FY14–FY26.

The pipeline shows the same pattern. Among NIRF-ranked engineering colleges, the number of graduates placed fell for the class of 2023-24, the first fall in the series, even as the number of graduates rose. [19] Real pay of IT workers aged 21–25 fell 12% in 2025, while pay of those aged 31–40 fell 2%. [20]

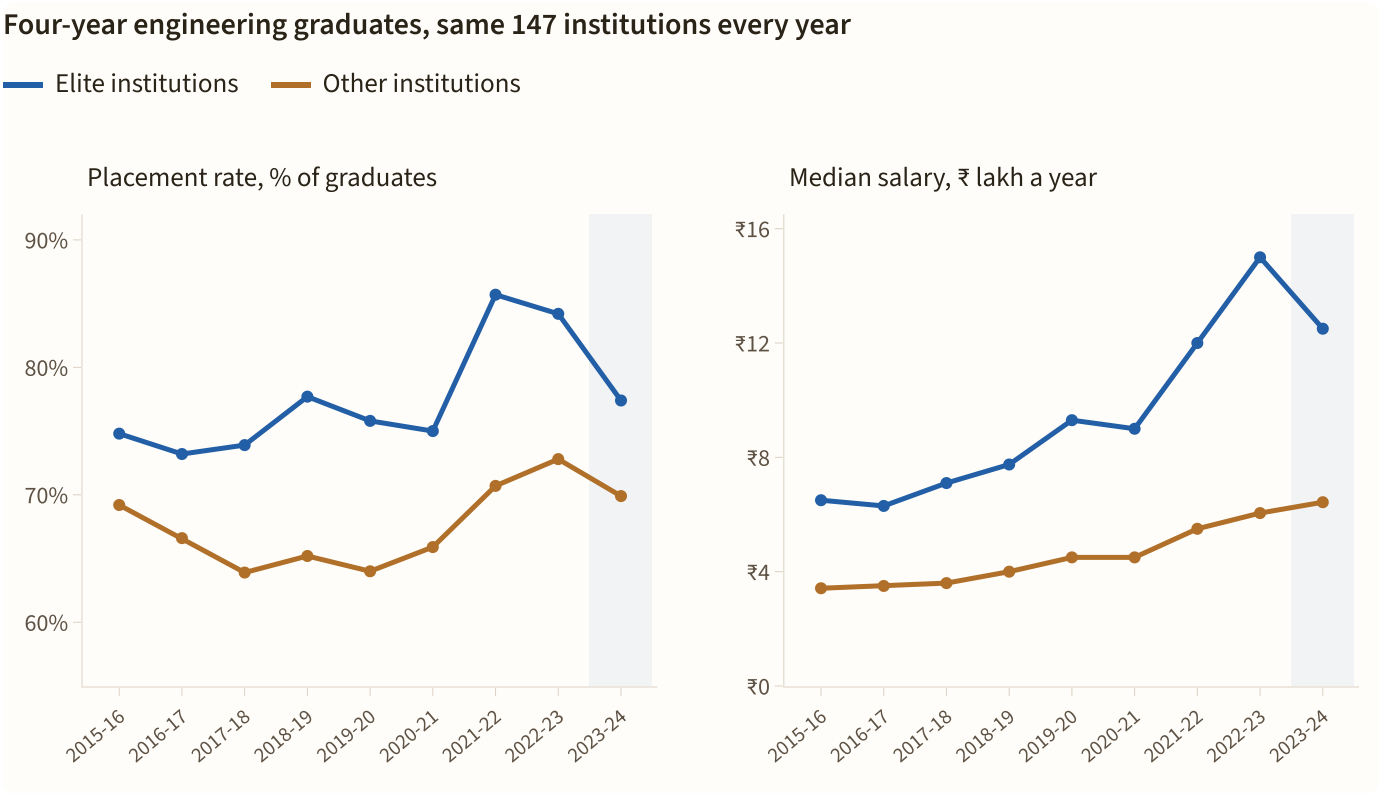


Figure 15. Placement rate and median salary of four-year engineering graduates by graduating class, NIRF-ranked institutions, elite and other.

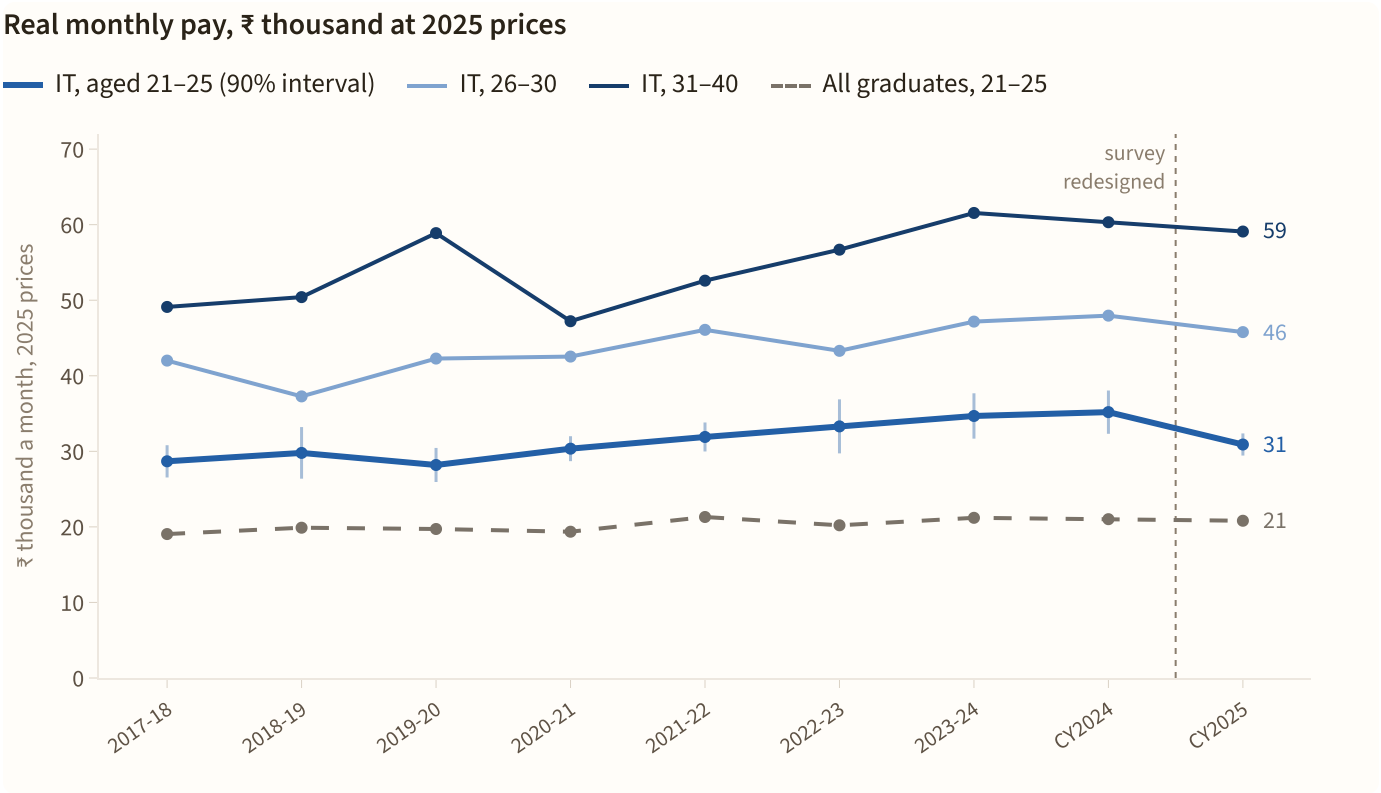


Figure 16. Real monthly pay of salaried IT workers by age, and of all graduates aged 21–25, at 2025 prices. The 2025 survey was redesigned.

Job postings point the same way. In the World Bank's analysis of Lightcast postings in South Asia, postings in AI-exposed occupations that asked for up to five years' experience fell most after ChatGPT, while those asking for ten or more years did not fall. [21]

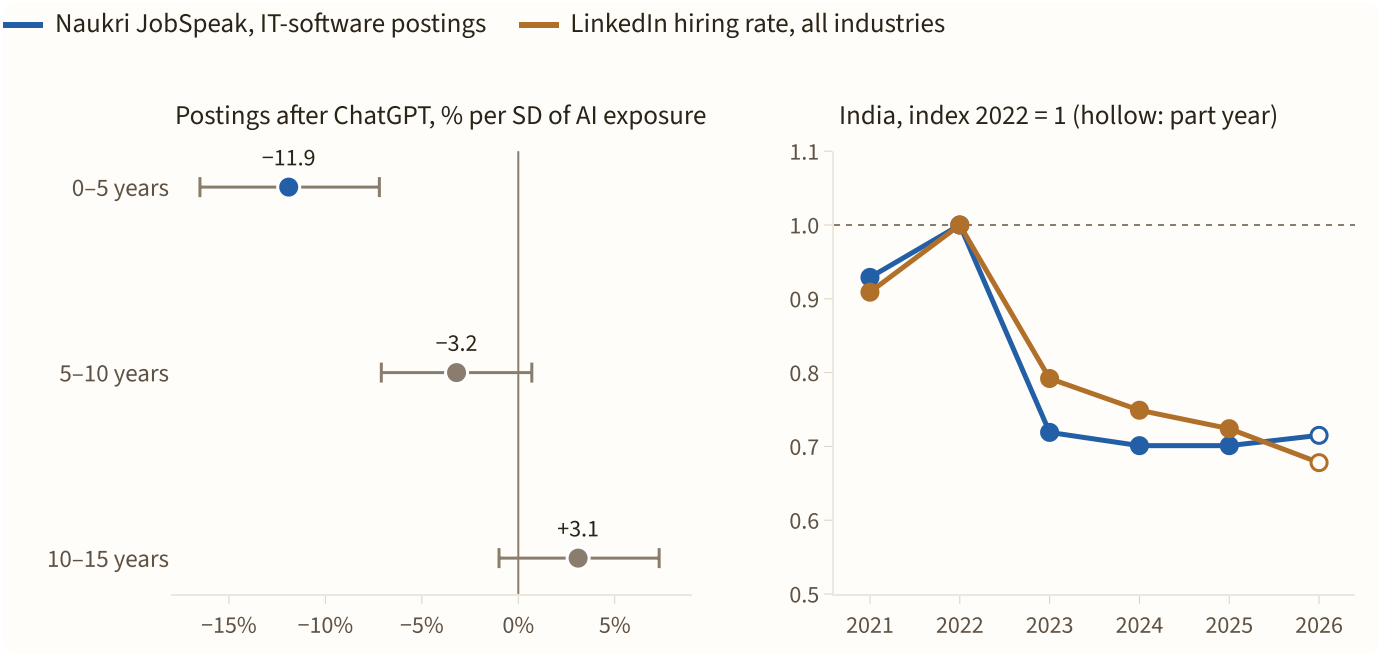


Figure 17. Change in job postings after November 2022 per standard deviation of AI exposure, by experience required, with 95% confidence intervals. South Asia, mostly India; Lightcast data analysed by the World Bank.

Evidence against a collapse

Several indicators qualify the picture above.

- **Counts have recovered.** Sector fresher intake roughly doubled from FY24 to FY25 on Xpheno's estimates, and TeamLease's employer survey shows IT firms' hiring intentions rebounding in 2025–26. [22]
- **Fresher postings outside IT are strong.** Naukri's postings for 0–3 years' experience, across all industries, are back to their 2022 level. IT postings remain about 30% below.
- **Graduate unemployment is high but not rising.** About 40% of graduates aged 15–25 in the labour force were unemployed in 2023-24, close to State of Working India's figure. The rate fell from about 48% in 2017-18, and on the weekly measure it has not moved since.

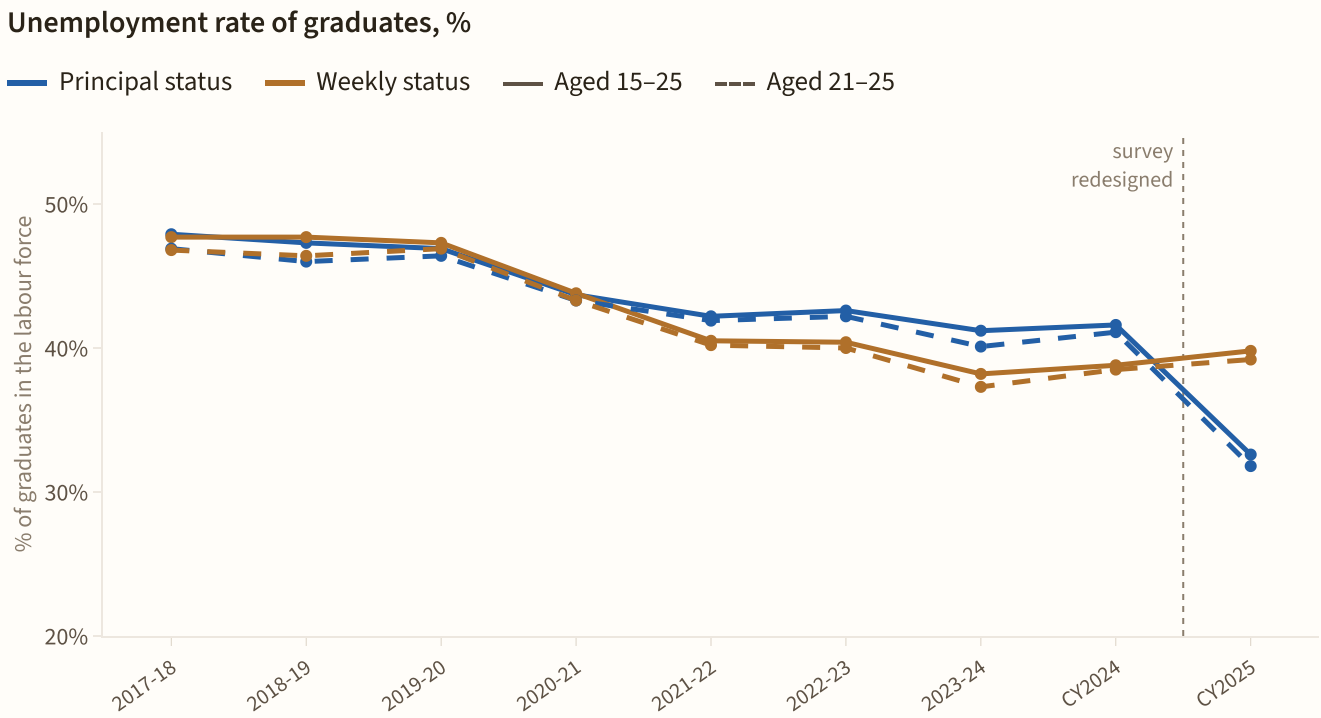


Figure 18. Unemployment rate of graduates aged 15–25 and 21–25, on the principal-status and weekly-status measures.

- **The decline is milder than abroad.** India's technology postings and hiring fell by about a third from 2022. Software postings in the US and UK fell by about two-thirds.

6 The firms show little strain

The six firms are not in financial distress. Attrition is back to 12–14%, from 22–28% at its 2022 peak. Utilisation is at or above its pre-COVID average at the four firms that report it, and the value of deals signed over the past year is flat or rising.

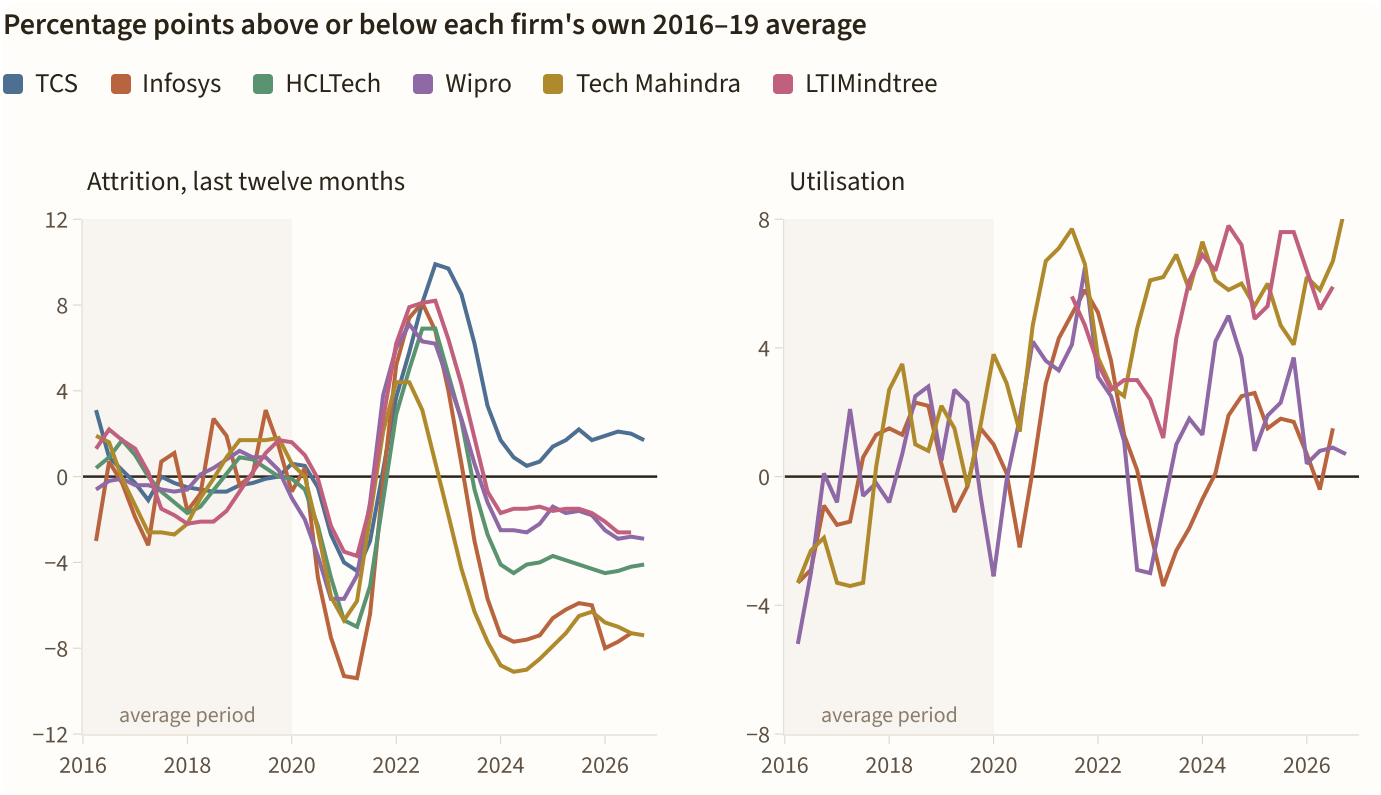


Figure 19. Attrition and utilisation by firm, quarterly, against each firm's 2016–19 average.

Workers' share of value added at the six firms has held at about 0.7 since FY16. Pay and value added per average employee both rose about 21% from FY23 to FY26. The firms have become smaller relative to their output, more senior and more expensive per head, but not more profitable at their workers' expense. [23]

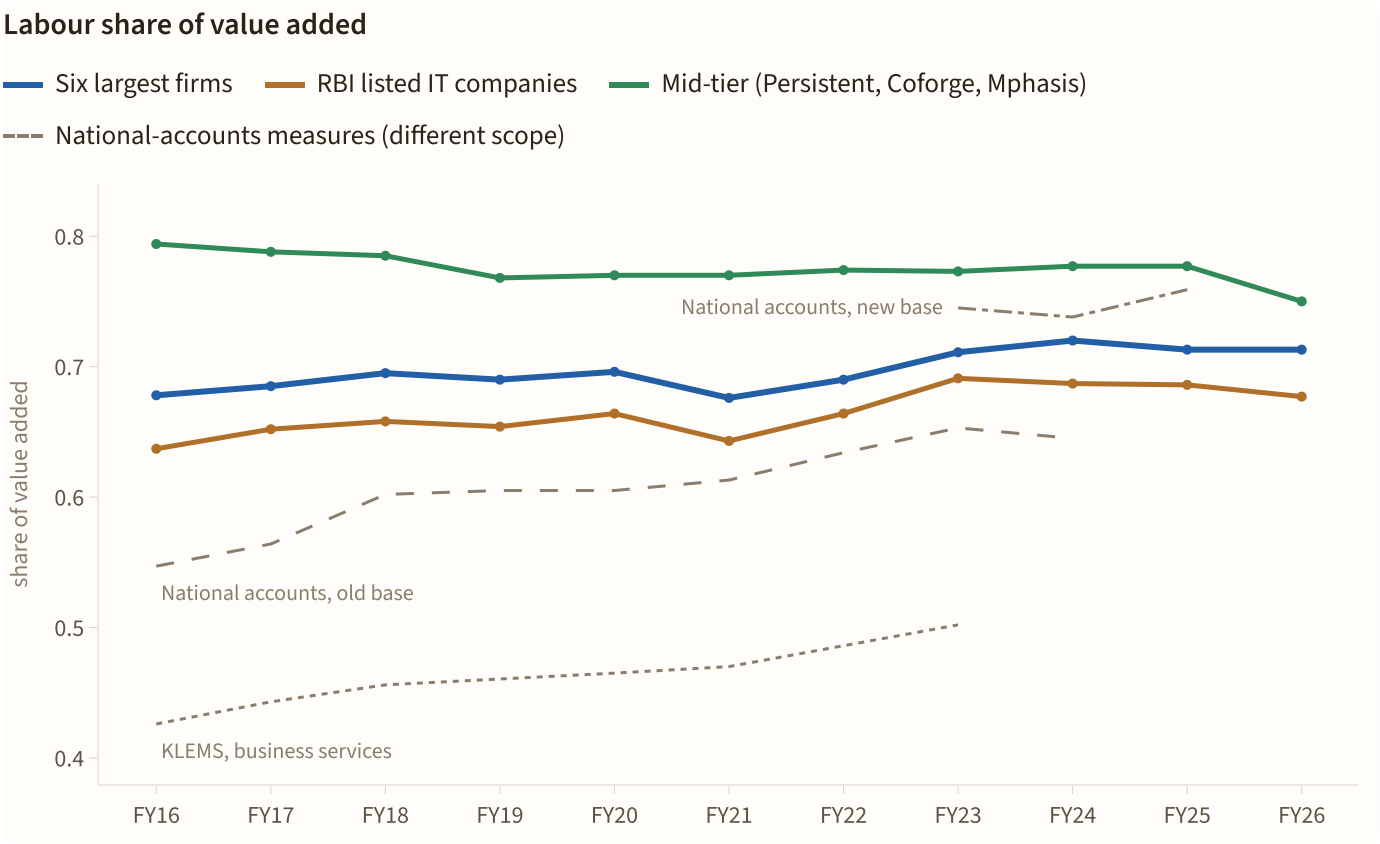


Figure 20. Labour share of value added: the six largest firms, listed IT firms in the RBI's company data, and three mid-tier firms, FY16–FY26.

Prices have barely moved. No official price index covers IT services. [24] Firms' own statements on earnings calls imply AI-related price cuts of 0.1% in FY25 and 0.4% in FY26, with about 1.5% expected in FY27. Brokers' forecasts of 2–3.5% a year of "AI deflation" include the routine annual discounts of about 1.5% that predate AI. [25]

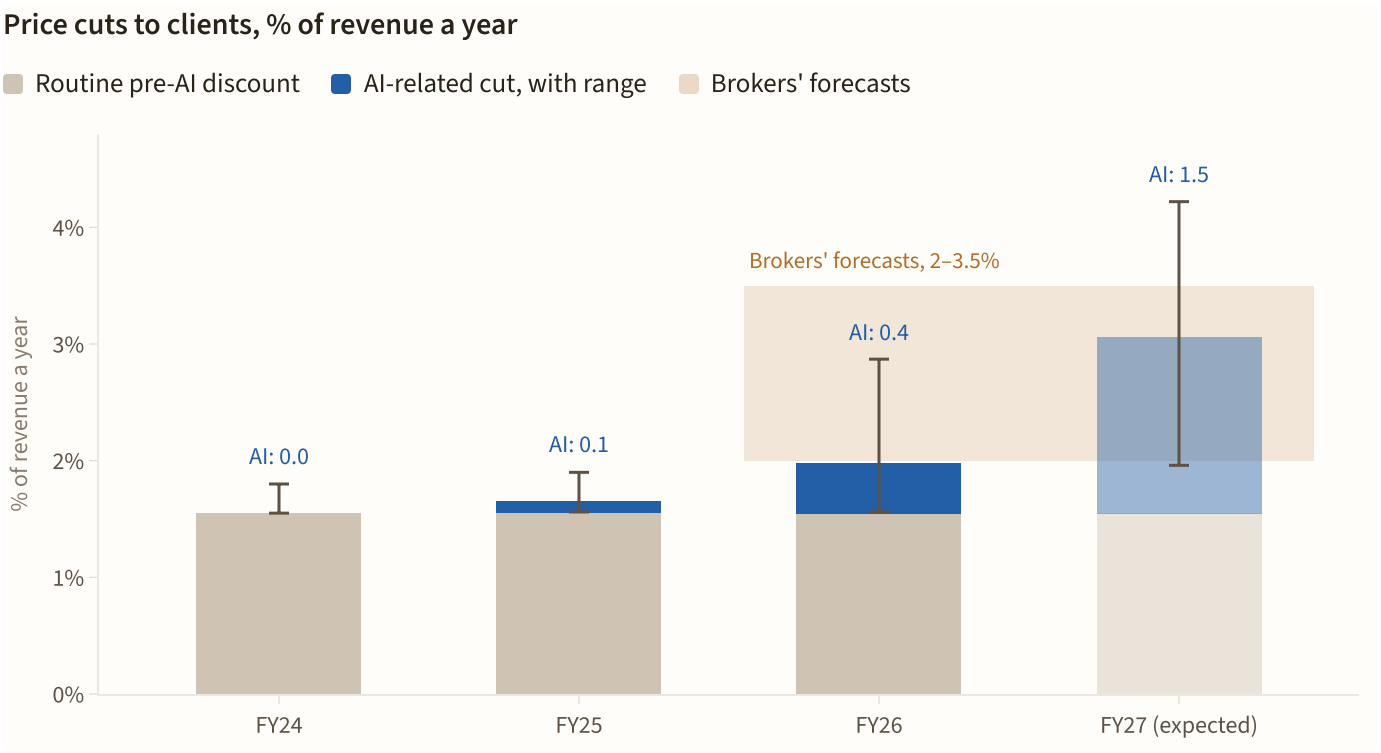


Figure 21. AI-related price cuts implied by management statements, FY24–FY27, with range; the band shows brokers' forecasts.

7 Client demand has softened and shifted

The United States buys about 54% of India's IT exports, and its clients are doing more of this work themselves. The in-house share of US computer jobs rose from 64–65% in 2015–22 to 67.5% in 2025. Employment at US IT-services firms has fallen 5% since March 2023.

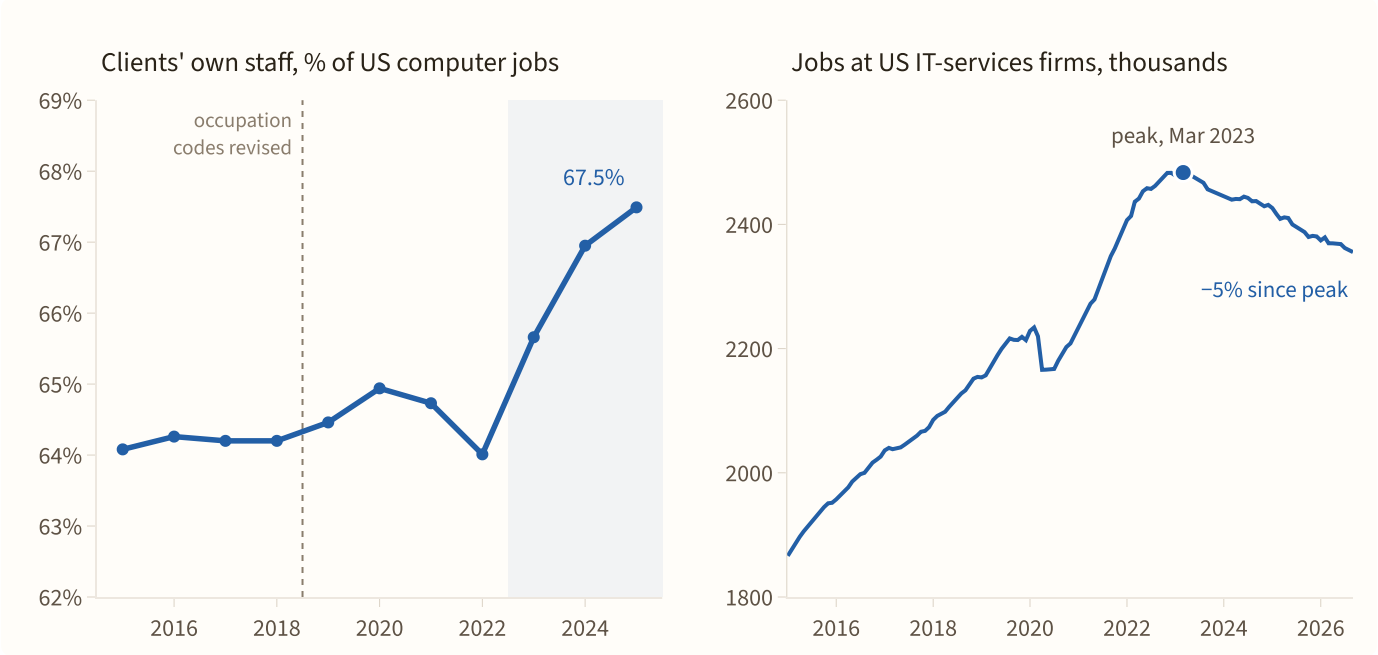


Figure 22. In-house share of US computer occupations, 2015–2025, and employment in US computer systems design firms (NAICS 5415), monthly.

On earnings calls, managers' talk of weak demand peaked in 2023 and has stayed well above pre-2022 levels. Mentions of AI, and of passing AI savings on to clients, have risen steeply since 2025.

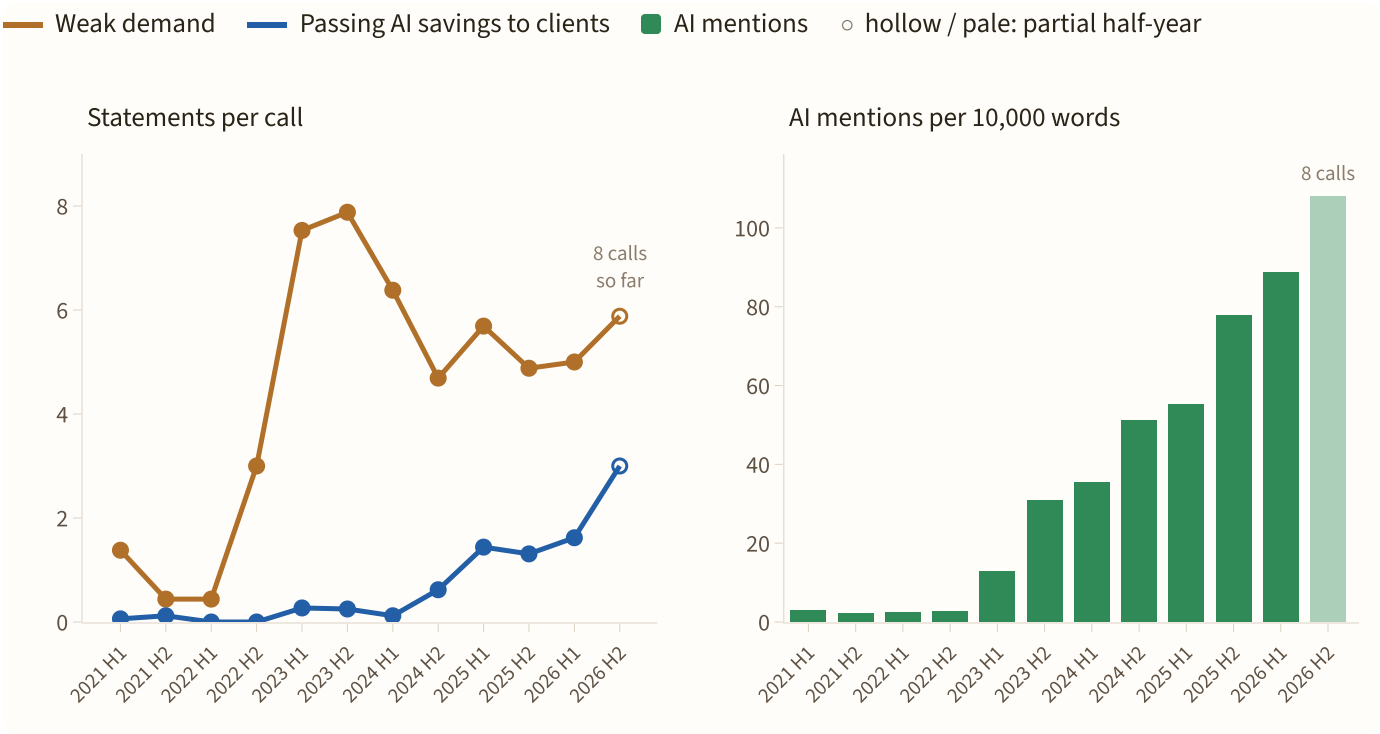


Figure 23. Earnings-call statements per call about weak demand and about passing AI savings to clients, and mentions of AI per 10,000 words, by half-year.

8 How other estimates compare

We checked widely cited figures against the sources above. Most are right about direction; several are wrong about size or meaning.

Table 2. Widely cited figures and what the data show

Claim	Source	What we find	Reproduced?
The industry added 135,000 jobs in FY26	Nasscom	Consistent with the PLFS	No
The rest of the sector added 700,000 jobs	Goldman Sachs, via World Bank	About 390,000 like for like	Partly
Employment has continued to grow	ICRIER	True to 2023-24; flat since	Yes
IT's share of young salaried graduates fell from 20.0% to 15.8%	Future of India	Correct	Yes
IT's share of value added going to labour has fallen	Future of India	Not on company or RBI data	Yes
About 40% of young graduates are unemployed	State of Working India	Correct on principal status	Yes
Entry-level hiring rose 168%	LinkedIn	Refers to hiring by firms of 1–10 staff	No
India's business-services exports are 27% above trend	Richard Baldwin	Correct; about half the gap predates ChatGPT	Yes
AI-exposed exports rose 39.5%	Economic Survey 2025-26	A relative estimate, not a growth rate	Yes
IT hiring fell from 600,000 to 140,000	Xpheno, via Economic Times	Fresher intake, not net hiring	No
AI will deflate prices by 2–3.5% a year	Brokers	Forecasts that include routine discounts	No

"Reproduced" means we rebuilt the figure from data we hold. The full catalogue of sources, with every number checked, is in the repository.

9 What to watch

- **FY27 results.** Infosys reports on 23 October. Whether the uptick in headcount and fresher hiring at TCS and HCLTech spreads to the other firms.
- **Prices.** Whether AI-related price cuts reach the 1.5% firms expect for FY27.

- **Coding agents.** Whether the mid-2026 jump in capability appears in FY27 hiring, especially at entry level.
- **GCCs.** The RBI's census of foreign-owned firms, due in late October 2026, is the best official read on captive centres.
- **Employment data.** PLFS 2026, and whether EPFO resumes its payroll releases, which stopped after September 2025.
- **Graduates.** NIRF placement data for the class of 2024-25.

Appendix

– Sources and methods

Firms. Quarterly filings, fact sheets and investor releases of TCS, Infosys, HCLTech, Wipro, Tech Mahindra, LTIMindtree (LTI and Mindtree before the merger), Accenture and Cognizant; annual reports of 21 other listed firms; ESG and GRI disclosures for age data. Growth rates are log changes unless stated. Headcounts are global.

Sector. RBI Survey on Computer Software and ITES Exports; IMF balance of payments and WTO trade-in-services data; US Bureau of Economic Analysis and Bureau of Labor Statistics; Nasscom and Nasscom–Zinnov industry estimates, used with care; RBI company finances and MoSPI national accounts for value added.

Workers. PLFS unit-level data, 2017-18 to 2025; EPFO monthly payroll reports to July 2025; NIRF institutional data for graduating classes 2015-16 to 2023-24; Naukri JobSpeak, foundit, Xpheno, TeamLease and LinkedIn as published; World Bank South Asia Development Update (October 2025) for Lightcast postings.

Prices and demand. Price statements from earnings calls of eight firms, 2021–2026, coded by two independent coders; BLS occupational and payroll employment.

– Figures we cite but cannot reproduce

Staffing-firm estimates of sector fresher intake (Xpheno, HAN Digital, TeamLease Digital) and of GCC hiring; Nasscom's employment and revenue estimates; Nasscom–Zinnov GCC counts; the Lightcast postings analysis; LinkedIn's hiring rate; foundit and Xpheno postings data; ICRIER's firm survey; brokers' forecasts. Each is labelled as such where it appears.

Corrections to figures in circulation

- TCS headcount in September 2026 was 4,700 *higher* than a year earlier, not 15,000 lower; it is 15,000 below its level of June 2025.
- The five largest firms' headcount fell by 6,981 in FY26, not 7,389.
- The five largest firms added about 160 people in the nine months to December 2025, not 17; both round to zero.
- Xpheno's "600,000 to 140,000" refers to fresher intake, not net hiring.

Data notes

- **PLFS 2025** uses a new design with monthly sampling and a sample about 2.5 times larger, so changes into 2025 combine real change with design effects. The 2023-24 round includes one sampling unit with a very large weight; without it, IT employment is about 0.3 million lower that year.
- **EPFO** figures are revised down heavily after first release; we use final annual totals. EPFO's industry tables show only the ten largest industries in each age band, so IT is visible only for ages 18–28.
- **Postings are not hires.** Large IT firms recruit freshers mostly through campus drives that job portals do not see.

PLFS acknowledgement

This page uses unit-level data from the Periodic Labour Force Survey, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), Government of India. Only aggregate tabulations are shown. The analysis and conclusions are ours, not MoSPI's.

All notes

1. The direct beneficiaries were mostly urban, middle-class graduates (Upadhya 2007). The sector's reach was wider, though. When recruiters for business-process firms were sent to villages, more young women took paid work and stayed in school (Jensen 2012), and a new IT-enabled services centre raised nearby primary-school enrolment by about 5% (Oster and Steinberg 2013).
2. For example, Rest of World (6 February 2026): "The Indian IT model is now facing existential pressure." Jefferies cut its price targets for Indian IT firms, citing AI-driven price deflation (Business Today, 23 February 2026).
3. Nasscom's estimates of direct employment rose from 3.7 million in FY16 to 4.36 million in FY20, about 4.2% a year, with net additions averaging about 160,000 a year. In the FY21–23 boom they averaged about 290,000.

Each Strategic Review restates earlier years, so we compare growth within editions. Sources are listed in data/explore/health_check/charts/nasscom_employment_history.csv.

4. In our PLFS tabulations, IT employed about 20% of salaried graduates aged 21–25 in 2022-23. Among employed engineering graduates aged 21–30, IT's share rose from about 30% in 2017-18 to 45–53% from 2021-22. State of Working India 2026 likewise finds computer and information services among the main employers of young graduates (IDR summary, 12 May 2026).
5. Exports in the RBI survey were 5.7% of GDP in FY26. Balance-of-payments figures, which classify the same exports differently, give a share nearer 8½% when business services are included.
6. Reuters reported that the sell-off began on 4 February 2026, after Anthropic released plug-ins for its Claude Cowork agent, and that AI fears had wiped about $50 billion off Indian IT stocks by mid-February (Reuters, 4 February 2026; Reuters, 24 February 2026). The fall was part of a broader sell-off in software stocks.
7. A separate working paper attempts that decomposition, under stated assumptions: two questions about AI and jobs in Indian IT.
8. Balance-of-payments data grow about twice as fast as the RBI survey over FY23–26 (39% against 19%). The survey is the more conservative measure, and we use it throughout.
9. Ireland's exports are mostly the booked revenue of US technology firms' European headquarters and swamp the world total. Including Ireland, India's share was 20.4% in 2022 and 19.5% in 2025.
10. No official statistic counts GCC employment. Our central estimate reconciles Nasscom–Zinnov reports, which are not comparable across editions, with staffing firms' hiring estimates. The plausible range is about 155,000 to 430,000 technology jobs.
11. GCC hiring was about 100,000–165,000 a year before 2023 and 94,000–180,000 after. In the RBI's census of foreign-owned firms, their exports grew about 5 points a year faster than total software exports in FY20–23 and about 4 points faster in FY24–25.
12. Usual-status workers in National Industrial Classification divisions 62 (computer programming and consultancy) and 63 (information services). BPM work is mostly classified elsewhere. All PLFS figures are our tabulations of MoSPI unit-level data.
13. World Bank, *India Development Update*, October 2026, p. 41, citing a Goldman Sachs client report (July 2026) that we could not obtain.
14. ICRIER, *AI and Jobs: This Time Is No Different* (February 2026), Section 7. The report's survey of 651 firms finds 55% reporting lower entry-level employment and 35% higher; we cannot reproduce it.
15. Xpheno, HAN Digital and TeamLease Digital, as reported in the press. None publishes its method. Xpheno's FY22 figure was about 450,000 when first estimated and 600,000 when quoted in 2026.
16. Business Today (21 March 2026) reports deferred offers at Wipro and Tech Mahindra.
17. The PLFS and EPFO shares are our tabulations. The Xpheno and foundit shares are as published and cannot be reproduced. EPFO's last annual figure is FY25.
18. Part of the fall is mechanical: staff hired in the FY22–23 boom are being promoted out of the junior grade and, from about FY30, will pass age 30. At Infosys, hiring of staff over 30 was about 65% higher a year in FY24–26 than in FY16–21, while hiring of under-30s was about the same.
19. Comparing the same institutions within the same NIRF edition: the number placed fell about 1.8% while graduates rose about 3.3%. Placements include all employers, GCCs among them.

20. Mean monthly earnings of regular salaried workers, deflated by the consumer price index. The 2025 fall coincides with the survey redesign and is a single year; earlier rounds show steady growth.
21. World Bank, *South Asia Development Update*, October 2025, Annex Table A2.12. Postings for 0–5 years of experience fell 11.9% per standard deviation of AI exposure; those for 10–15 years rose 3.1%, not significantly. The data end in March 2025.
22. TeamLease's survey changed its sample in 2025, so the size of the rebound is uncertain.
23. Labour share is employee costs divided by employee costs plus operating profit. A widely shared chart showing a falling labour share combines survey take-home pay with national-accounts output; on that basis the six firms' wage bill alone would exceed the whole sector's.
24. The US Bureau of Labor Statistics does not publish a producer price index for computer systems design, and no Indian index exists.
25. Coded from 108 statements on earnings calls and at investor days by eight IT firms and four BPO firms, converted to an effect on total revenue. The method and its assumptions are documented in the repository (round4/price_statements). The broker range is from Kotak, ICICI Securities and HCLTech's own guidance, as reported.

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